

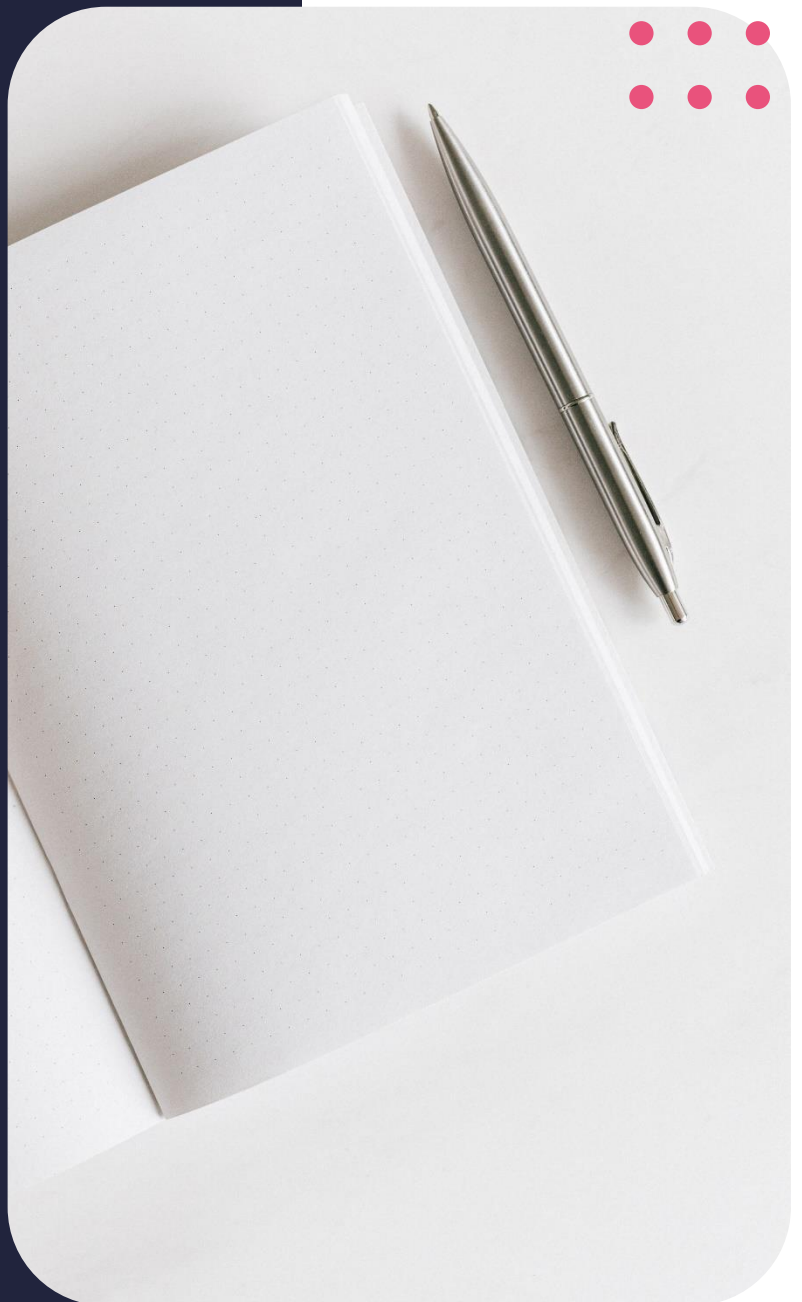
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Employee Engagement



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Lesson 8 Objectives

- Understand employee engagement
- Engagement tools
- Leadership and engagement

Lesson Introduction

As stated by (inside) Employee engagement is a property of the relationship between an organization and its employees. An “engaged employee” is one who is fully absorbed by and enthusiastic about their work and so takes positive action to further the organization's reputation and interests.

“When people are financially invested, they want a return. When people are emotionally invested, they want to contribute.”

- Simon Sinek

“Employees who believe that management is concerned about them as a whole person – not just an employee – are more productive, more satisfied, more fulfilled. Satisfied employees mean satisfied customers, which leads to profitability.”

- Anne M. Mulcahy

Key reading materials

- <https://www.forbes.com/sites/kevinkruse/2012/06/22/employee-engagement-what-and-why/#5624d82c7f37>
- <https://www.socialchorus.com/blog/employee-experience/employee-engagement-keyto-company-success/>
- <https://engagementforsuccess.org/what-is-employee-engagement>

Top ways to improve your employee engagement

Recognition

Recognition in the workplace can take on many forms. It can be as simple as a non-monetary Thank You or acknowledgment in front of their peers. It can also include monetary recognition such as bonuses, a salary increase, or a Total Recognition program where you can reward employees at every touchpoint with rewards. These points can be redeemed for things such as merchandise, gift cards, travel, and much more. Giving your employees personalized rewards that are unique to what they want is crucial.

Feedback

Feedback is an important element of your employee's growth and happiness. Feedback and coaching is an important element for engagement because your employees will feel like they are valued in the organization, they will know what they need to do to improve, and they will see that you are dedicated to their growth.

Alignment

Whether or not a person is aligned with your organization starts from the very minute they are hired. That's why it is important to hire employees who are a cultural fit

Job Fit & Compensation

Satisfaction is really an overall indicator of employee engagement. This can include elements such as compensation, work environment, and fit of a role for the employee. Some ways you can improve the overall satisfaction of your employees include providing them with a fair and competitive salary, offering them the flexibility to work remotely or flexible hours, providing them with autonomy and authority to do their role to the best of their ability.

Different employees engagement surveys



These are some great surveys that you can make use of. These are direct quotes regarding each survey type. (ETS)

1. Staff satisfaction surveys

A staff satisfaction survey measures employee's happiness with their current job. Typically, the information sought relates to 'HR issues' covering aspects such as pay and benefits and working conditions.

2. Employee engagement surveys

An employee engagement survey measures their emotional commitment to the organisation, highlighting things like their willingness to put in discretionary effort, whether they'd recommend the organisation and their intention to remain working there in the future.

3. Kiosk surveys

Surveying employees in 'real-time' is a prominent trend, particularly in a number of global businesses. They're looking for an 'always on' approach capturing employees' feelings and views. They achieve this by deploying survey kiosks in offices or other communal staff areas. Employees are asked just one (or a few) simple questions like "did you feel valued at work today?"

Companies such as DHL, eBay, Microsoft and Nike use similar types of real-time surveys for their employees.

4. Mood surveys

These are ultra-simple surveys intended to get a very quick overview of the mood among a workforce. Such surveys can come in the form of an online, tablet or smartphone app or on a dedicated device (such as a kiosk – see above). They make participation quick and straightforward typically using touch-based icons (i.e. smiley face), coloured buttons or a slider scale to indicate how they currently feel.

5. Pulse surveys

Pulse surveys, or snap surveys as they're sometimes called, are typically smaller in scale with less employees invited to take part and/or the fewer number of questions in the survey. Naturally, this reduces the resulting admin. The frequency of 'pulse check' surveys is most commonly either monthly or quarterly. Such surveys may be used to check-in on engagement or prominent themes from a full engagement survey or to gauge employees' views on hot topics.

Pulse surveys have become increasingly prevalent. Among companies known to use pulse surveys to supplement a bigger annual survey and focus on key themes from the full survey or local priority actions are our clients M&S and ITV.

6. IVR (telephone) surveys

IVR or Interactive Voice Response surveys, to give them their full name, are telephone-based. Most commonly associated with gaining customer feedback, IVR surveys can also be a useful survey methodology for when you have groups of employees that are based remotely and perhaps don't have ready access to the internet.

7. Pull surveys

Some organisations favour a local approach to engagement. They want to give local teams the autonomy and ability to 'pull' (or request) an employee survey rather than 'push' it. This obviously gives local managers ownership of the process and enables them to create and run surveys on an ad hoc basis to suit their needs. Several organisations we've recently begun working with have asked us for 'self-service' employee survey tools. Their intention is to give the power to local teams, regions or business units to create their own 'pull surveys' when needed.

8. Culture surveys

Organisational culture is now widely regarded as a top priority for businesses. Naturally, organisations undergoing cultural change are keen to measure progress on this. To do this, they may use a culture survey to get employees' views on the working culture and identify any obstacles to the desired new culture.

9. Joiners' surveys

The opening weeks and months in a new job is a formative and hugely important time for employees. Put simply, first impressions count. Many organisations therefore survey new joiners after their first week or month (or both) to capture, among other things, their views on the hiring and on-boarding process.